

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

only part of her job she enjoyed was when she could work on problem solving.

Her father, an accountant for a big-eight firm, sent her to a vocational counselor who discovered the cause of her discomfort. She had a "creative" personality that required frequent change and challenging tasks. The last thing she needed was routine functions. He recommended that she go to a law school (a long-time desire) and study investigative law. She did so, and now is an investigator with a government securities agency and loves it. Her father was wise enough to point her in the right direction.

The next step is to help your older teenagers gather some career facts. Even if you can't determine the exact career field before they get involved, usually you can help them avoid the ones where they wouldn't fit. Perhaps the simplest way is to talk to Christians in those careers. Ask fundamental questions such as: (1) what kind of education is required; (2) what training is required; (3) what personality type performs best; (4) what hours do you work?

My daughter had always wanted to be a veterinarian, primarily because she loved animals. Later in college, she changed her mind and decided that she wanted to be a physician. After many long conversations with friends of mine who are medical doctors, her career field changed to psychology. She found that she wasn't willing to pay the price (in time) that a physician pays. She was able to make that decision without wasting several years of schooling simply by talking with others who had already gone the route.

(2) *Self-determination*. Within limits, from about 16 or 17 years on, you need to allow your children to make their own financial decisions. Certainly the decisions you allow will vary by age and personality, but the more opportunities you allow now, the clearer picture you'll have of what they will do later.

CLOTHES: As any mother of teenagers knows, it's hard to select the clothes that you can afford and they will wear. At some point you need to shift the decision-making process over to them